



PAPUA NEW GUINEA

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 24 JUNE 2026 - 30 JUNE 2026

BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

The operating picture for Papua New Guinea this period looks to be deteriorating: the bulk of reporting concerns aviation and airport disruption concentrated around National Capital District and Eastern Highlands. For business users, the principal business risk is direct exposure to violence and disruption at affected sites.

TOP 3 DEVELOPMENTS

Ten Charged with Murder Over Death of Security Guard

HIGH

Homicide / violent crime · National Capital District · Occurred 16 Jun · reported 24 Jun 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)
Heightened personal-security risk locally; review after-hours exposure and movement protocols.

Tribal foundation helped displaced SARV victims

HIGH

Other security · Reported 25 Jun 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)
Security-relevant development; monitor for operational follow-on in the affected area.

Australian support keeps Adventist Aviation in the air

LOW

Aviation / airport · Morobe · Reported 29 Jun 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)
Possible flight-schedule and airport-access disruption affecting travel and air freight.

INCIDENT DETAILS

OTHER OPERATIONAL DISRUPTION

Operational disruption to transport, utilities or connectivity was reported, including aviation and airport, power and utilities and other security. It concentrated in National Capital District, West New Britain and Madang. Disruption of this kind can interrupt operations, logistics and connectivity.

CURRENT SITUATION

The security picture in Papua New Guinea this period was dominated by aviation and airport disruption, other security-relevant incidents and power and utility disruption. Reporting clustered around National Capital District, Eastern Highlands and Morobe. The most serious entry reached High severity.

The picture is operational rather than a single dramatic event: the priority for business users is movement security, premises protection and continuity at exposed sites while this picture holds.

OPERATIONAL IMPACT

- Protest & civil unrest - Gatherings and crowd-control responses can close roads and disrupt access at short notice; build in transit buffers and keep routes flexible.
- Crime, theft & robbery - Direct threat to staff, premises and the movement of cash or assets; harden security, vary routines and brief travellers.
- Natural hazards - Weather and geological hazards can interrupt transport, utilities and site access; check conditions before movement and confirm site readiness.
- Governance & regulatory - Regulatory, policing and political-stability friction can affect compliance, permits and freedom of movement; monitor official guidance.
- Other operational disruption - Transport, utilities and connectivity disruption can interrupt operations and logistics; plan for contingencies and alternate routing.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

MOVEMENT SECURITY

- Vary routes and timings, avoid predictable patterns, and confirm route status before travel.
- Route around gatherings, rallies and choke points, and build in extra transit time.
- Treat areas with confirmed violence as no-go for non-essential travel; use secure transport for any essential movement.

SITE SECURITY

- Maintain premises protection: access control, guarding and after-hours security at exposed sites.

STAFF AWARENESS

- Brief staff and travellers on current risks, local reporting lines and areas to avoid.
- Remind staff to keep a low profile with cash, devices and valuables in public.

JOURNEY PLANNING

- Confirm road, air and port status before travel and hold viable alternates.
- Check weather and hazard conditions before movement and allow for delays.

ESCALATION TRIGGERS

- Activate contingency and movement-restriction plans if higher-severity or casualty-bearing incidents reach or near operating sites.

LOCAL MONITORING

- Track local reporting and official advisories for the locations on the watchlist, and reassess as fresh

reporting comes through.

OUTLOOK: NEXT SEVEN DAYS

The coming week most likely follows the current pattern, led by aviation and airport disruption, with other security-relevant incidents also likely to recur. Key locations to watch: National Capital District and Eastern Highlands.

Escalation triggers: a spread of high-severity or casualty-bearing incidents beyond the locations above, and flashpoints around paydays, court rulings, election cycles and tribal-payback events.

Concern would ease with a sustained quiet stretch across National Capital District and Eastern Highlands, no further high-severity or casualty-bearing incidents, and no spread to new districts. Were the picture to deteriorate, expect direct disruption to movement and site access at the affected locations, with knock-on delays to staff travel and logistics.

ESCALATION INDICATORS

- Larger or coordinated protest mobilisation, or labour action spreading to key sites and corridors
- Further casualty-bearing or higher-severity violence at or near operating sites
- Spread of incidents beyond Port Moresby / National Capital District and Eastern Highlands into new districts

POLESTAR VIEW

Polestar assesses that operating risk in Papua New Guinea is deteriorating, driven by transport and utility disruption, crime and violent incidents and protest and civil unrest. The main business exposure is logistics, business continuity and staff safety. The most exposed areas are Port Moresby / National Capital District, Eastern Highlands and Lae / Morobe. The most likely disruption over the next seven days is continued transport, utility or connectivity disruption. The assessment would worsen if larger-scale incidents, casualty-bearing violence or sustained disruption emerge around paydays, court rulings, election cycles and tribal-payback events. For now, operators should tighten movement planning and site protection at the exposed locations and keep contingency arrangements under active review.

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